

Word family: **refuge / refuges / refugee**

Base word: refuge

Plural: refuges

Related form: refugee

Part of speech: noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “At that time, I was easily distracted at home, so the library felt like a **refuge** to me.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **refuge** means a **safe, peaceful place where someone can escape from stress, noise, danger, or difficulty**.

In your sentence, the library is not literally protecting the speaker from physical danger. It is a figurative refuge from distraction and noise.

繁體中文： **避風港；庇護所；讓人暫時逃離壓力、混亂或困擾的安全 / 平靜地方**

中文翻譯：

> “...the library felt like a **refuge** to me.”

「.....那座圖書館對我來說就像一個**避風港 / 安靜的庇護所**。」

Here:

refuge = 一個讓自己暫時遠離干擾、壓力和喧囂的安全空間

1. **refuge = shelter/protection from danger (避難所) — 庇護；避難所**

Meaning: A place or state of safety where someone is protected from danger, violence, bad weather, etc.

Practice 1

> “The villagers sought **refuge** from the storm.”

「村民尋找地方**避難**，躲避暴風雨。」

Practice 2

> “The cave provided **refuge** from the cold.”

「山洞提供了躲避寒冷的**庇護**。」

refuge = 在危險、惡劣天氣或威脅下提供保護和安全的地方 / 狀態

Common:

- * seek refuge
- * take refuge
- * find refuge
- * provide refuge

2. **refuge** = peaceful escape from stress/difficulty (比喻) — 避風港；心靈庇護所

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A person, place, or activity that gives relief from stress, noise, emotional pressure, or difficulty.

Practice 3 — Original

> “The library felt like a **refuge** to me.”

「圖書館對我來說像一個**避風港**。」

Practice 4

> “Music became a **refuge** during a difficult period.”

「在一段艱難時期，音樂成了他的**心靈避風港**。」

Practice 5

> “The garden is a quiet **refuge** from city life.”

「這座花園是逃離城市生活的一處安靜**避風港**。」

refuge = 讓人暫時擺脫壓力、混亂、噪音或情緒困擾的地方 / 事物

This is a major figurative extension of the physical-safety sense.

3. **refuge = protected place for animals/plants (保護區) — 保護區；棲息庇護地**

Refuge can refer to a protected area for wildlife.

Practice 6

> “The wetlands are an important wildlife **refuge**.”

「這片濕地是一個重要的野生動物**保護區**。」

Practice 7

> “The island serves as a **refuge** for rare birds.”

「這座島是珍稀鳥類的重要**庇護地**。」

refuge = 為動植物提供保護、安全棲息地的地方

This is an established domain use.

4. **refuge = protection/asylum given by a place or institution (庇護) — 庇護；收容**

In formal contexts, **refuge** can refer more abstractly to protection offered to people fleeing danger or persecution.

Practice 8

> “The country offered **refuge** to families fleeing the conflict.”

「該國為逃離衝突的家庭提供**庇護**。」

Practice 9

> “They sought **refuge** across the border.”

「他們越過邊境尋求**庇護**。」

refuge = 為逃離危險、迫害或戰亂的人提供安全保護

For strict counting, this belongs to Meaning 1 rather than needing a separate core sense.

Related form: **refugee**

A **refugee** is a person who has been forced to leave their country or home because of war, persecution, or danger.

Practice 10

> “The camp provided shelter for thousands of **refugees**.”

「這個營地為數千名**難民**提供住宿。」

Practice 11

> “Many **refugees** had crossed the border.”

「很多**難民**已越過邊境。」

refugee = 因戰爭、迫害或嚴重危險而被迫離開原居地的人

This is a related lexical family member, but not simply another meaning of **refuge**.

Important distinction: **refuge** vs **shelter**

shelter

emphasizes physical protection, especially from weather or danger.

refuge

can be physical or figurative and often suggests:

- * safety
- * relief
- * escape from difficulty

> storm shelter

> emotional refuge

There is overlap, but **refuge** is broader and often more literary.

Important distinction: **refuge** vs **sanctuary**

sanctuary

often means a place of safety and protection, sometimes with a stronger sense of:

- * peace
- * sacredness
- * legal protection

refuge

is more general.

- > animal sanctuary
- > refuge from violence

Both can overlap strongly.

Important distinction: **refuge vs haven**

haven

means a safe or peaceful place.

refuge

more strongly suggests protection or escape from something difficult.

- > safe haven
- > refuge from danger

Haven often sounds warmer or more positive; **refuge** often foregrounds what one is escaping from.

Important distinction: **refuge vs escape**

escape

focuses on getting away from something.

refuge

focuses on the safe place or state you reach.

- > escape from stress
- > find refuge from stress

Different focus.

Important distinction: **refuge vs asylum**

asylum

can mean legal/protected status granted to someone fleeing persecution or danger.

refuge

is broader and does not necessarily refer to legal status.

- > seek asylum
- > seek refuge

They overlap, but **asylum** is more legal/institutional.

Grammar note: **refuge from**

A very common pattern is:

- > **refuge from + problem/danger**

Examples:

- * refuge from the rain
- * refuge from violence
- * refuge from stress
- * refuge from city noise

Grammar note: **seek/take/find refuge**

Common verb combinations:

- > seek refuge
- > take refuge
- > find refuge

Examples:

> “They took refuge in a church.”

「他們到一間教堂**避難**。」

> “She found refuge in books.”

「她在書本中找到**心靈避風港**。」

Countability note

Refuge can be both countable and uncountable-like.

Countable place

> “The cabin became a refuge.”

「那間小屋成為一個避難所。」

Abstract/protection

> “They sought refuge.”

「他們尋求庇護。」

So the grammar depends on whether we mean:

* a specific safe place

* the abstract state/protection of safety

Family-extension note

The practical modern family is fairly compact:

* **refuge**

* **refuges**

* **refugee**

The core semantic image is very stable:

> **protection or safety from something threatening or difficult**

The main split worth teaching is between:

- * literal physical protection
- * figurative emotional/mental escape

Wildlife refuge is a domain extension of the same safety/protection concept.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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refuge — physical safety	躲避危險、暴力或惡劣環境的庇護 / 避難場所
refuge — figurative	讓人暫時逃離壓力、噪音、混亂或情緒困擾的避風港
refuge — wildlife	為動植物提供保護和安全棲息環境的保護區 / 庇護地
refuge — protection/asylum	為逃離危險、迫害或衝突的人提供的安全庇護
refugee	因戰爭、迫害或危險而被迫離開原居地的人；難民

For your original sentence

> “At that time, I was easily distracted at home, so the library felt like a **refuge** to me.”

The exact meaning is:

refuge = 一個讓我暫時離開干擾、噪音和壓力，並感到平靜安全的地方

So:

> **the library felt like a refuge**

= **圖書館對我來說就像一個避風港**

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings** for **refuge**:

- literal shelter/protection from danger**
- figurative place or activity that gives relief from stress/difficulty**

I would merge wildlife and asylum-like protection uses under #1 as domain extensions, and keep **refugee** as a related lexical family member rather than inflate the noun count.